Recessed-panel wainscoting — project specification

New L-shaped great room (former dining + living + primary bedroom). Kitchen, remaining bedroom and baths are out of scope.

Build method

Walls are first skinned with hardboard for a dead-flat, texture-free substrate. Skim sheets are ripped to the bay width of each run so that **every vertical board seam falls directly under a vertical trim member** and is permanently concealed. A picture-frame grid of trim (ripped from 1×6 MDF) is then applied over the skim, creating three rows of recessed panels. Finish is a dark paint (clubhouse look). Faux ceiling beams are a separate scope item.

Panel configuration — the rule for every wall

Three panel rows per bay. The **middle row (B) is a fixed 30" square opening** — the hero panel. Rows A and C are equal and simply absorb the remaining height. Carpenter field-measures each wall's exact ceiling and splits A / C evenly — the middle-square method.

CEILING	BASEBOARD	TRIM / RAILS	ROW B (SQUARE)	ROWS A & C
7'-11-3/4"	**5-1/2"**	**2-1/2" wide**	**30" × 30"**	**≈ 25-1/8"**

Run schedule

Run	Wall	Length	Bays	Bay width (o.c.)	Opening width
R1	Dining long wall	16'-8"	6	33-1/3"	30-7/8"
R2	Living long wall	16'-1"	6	32-1/6"	29-5/8"
R3	Dining end wall	13'-0"	5	31-1/5"	28-3/4"
R4	Living end wall	13'-0"	5	31-1/5"	28-3/4"
R6	Inside-L wall (bedroom to corner)	10'-10-1/2"	4	32-5/8"	30-1/8"
R5	Bump-out (3 segments)	8'-7" / 8'-6" / 5'-11"	3 / 3 / 2	~34"	~31-1/2"

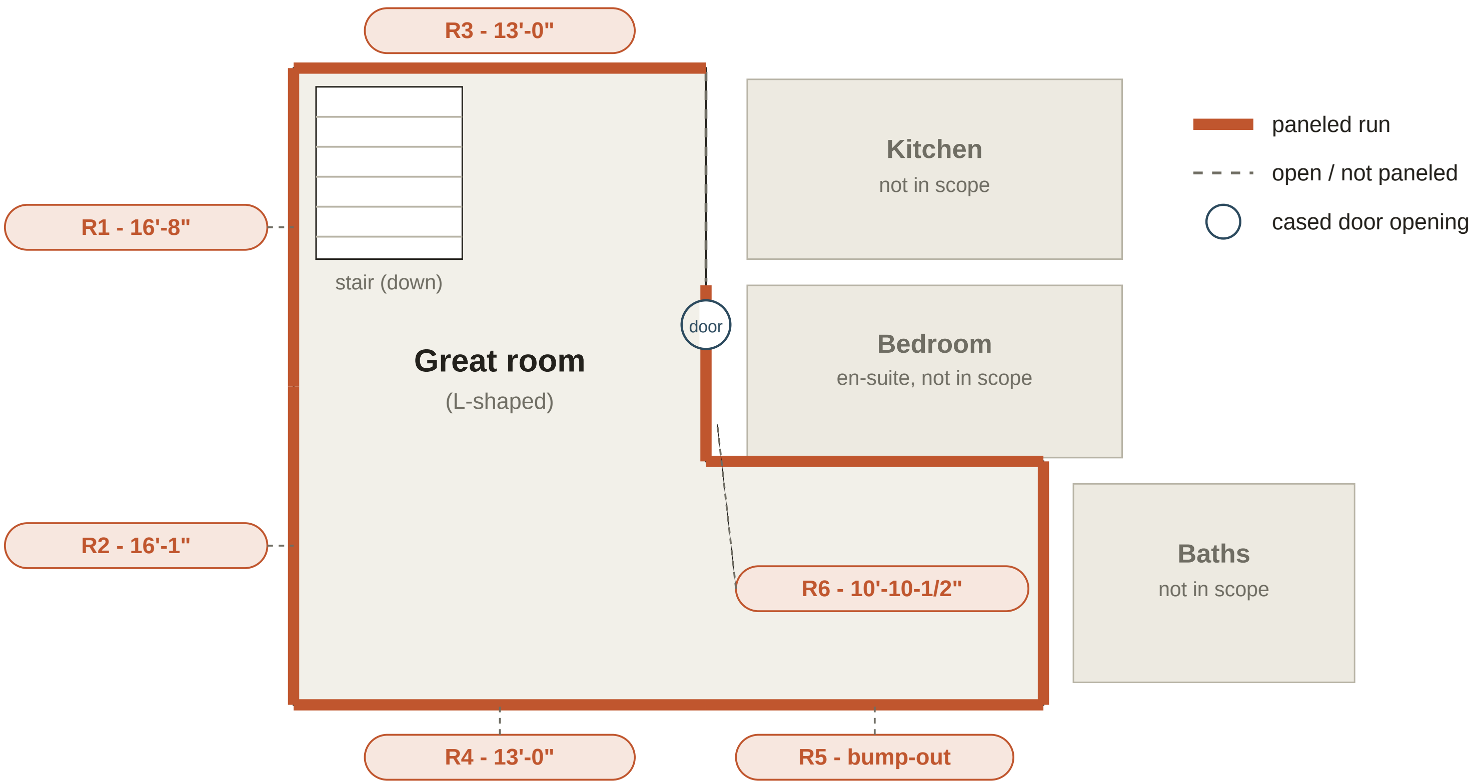
Totals: 34 bays · 102 recessed panels across 6 runs / 9 wall segments. Bay width is tuned per run so each wall ends on equal full panels — no slivers.

R6 is the inside face of the L. The bedroom keeps its entry door (cased opening); the small bathroom's living-room door is sealed and paneled over so the bath becomes an en-suite.

Field-verify items: the LiDAR floor plan is approximate. Confirm all run lengths on site, the net paneled length where R3 meets the kitchen / bar opening, the stair termination on R1, and the three R5 segment lengths before cutting.

Plan key — paneled runs

Identifies which elevation sheet belongs to which wall. Right side of the great room opens to kitchen, bedroom & baths and is not paneled.

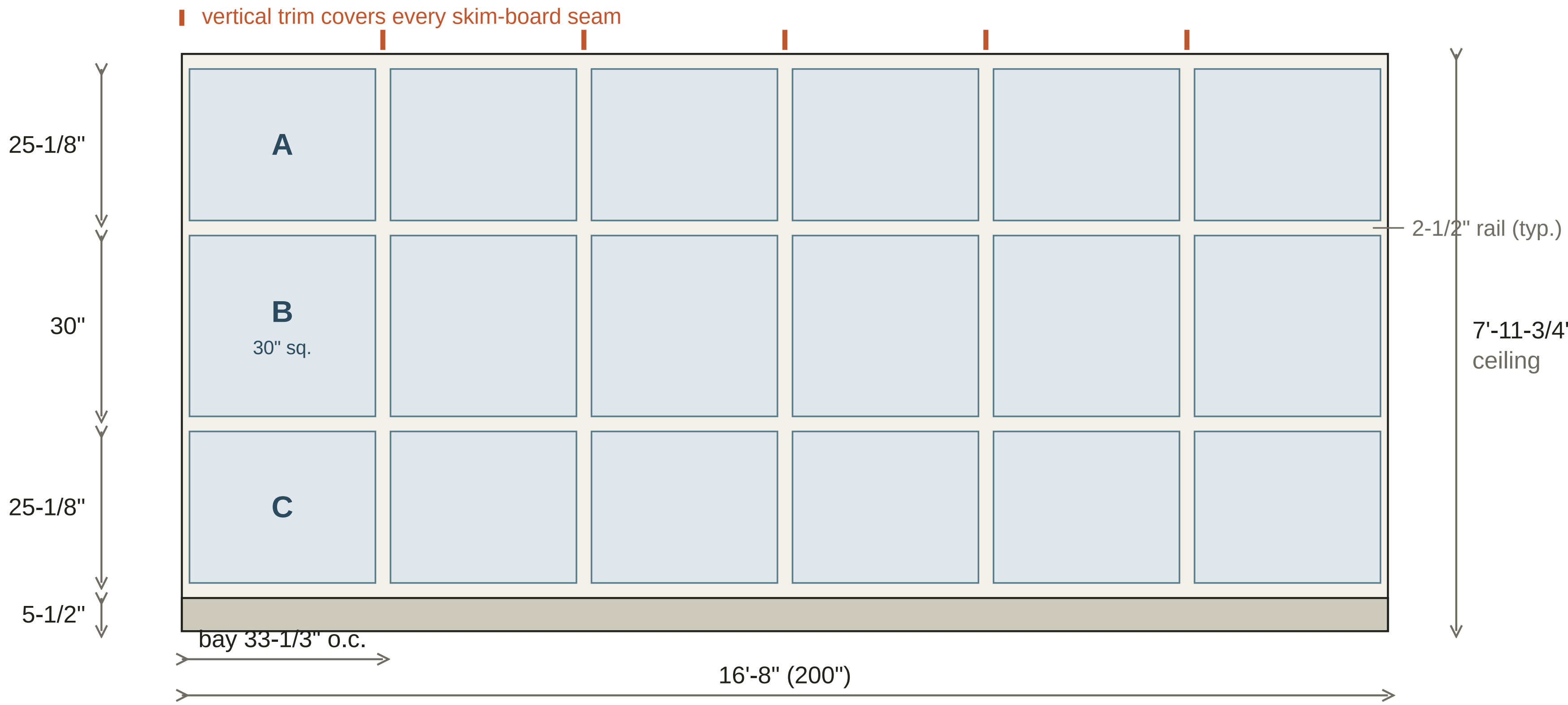


Schematic for wall identification only. LiDAR floor plan is approximate - field-verify every run length.

R6 added: inside face of the L. Bedroom keeps its entry door; the bathroom's living-room door is sealed and paneled over.

R1 — Dining long wall

Left exterior wall, dining portion · 16'-8" · 6 bays · 18 panels

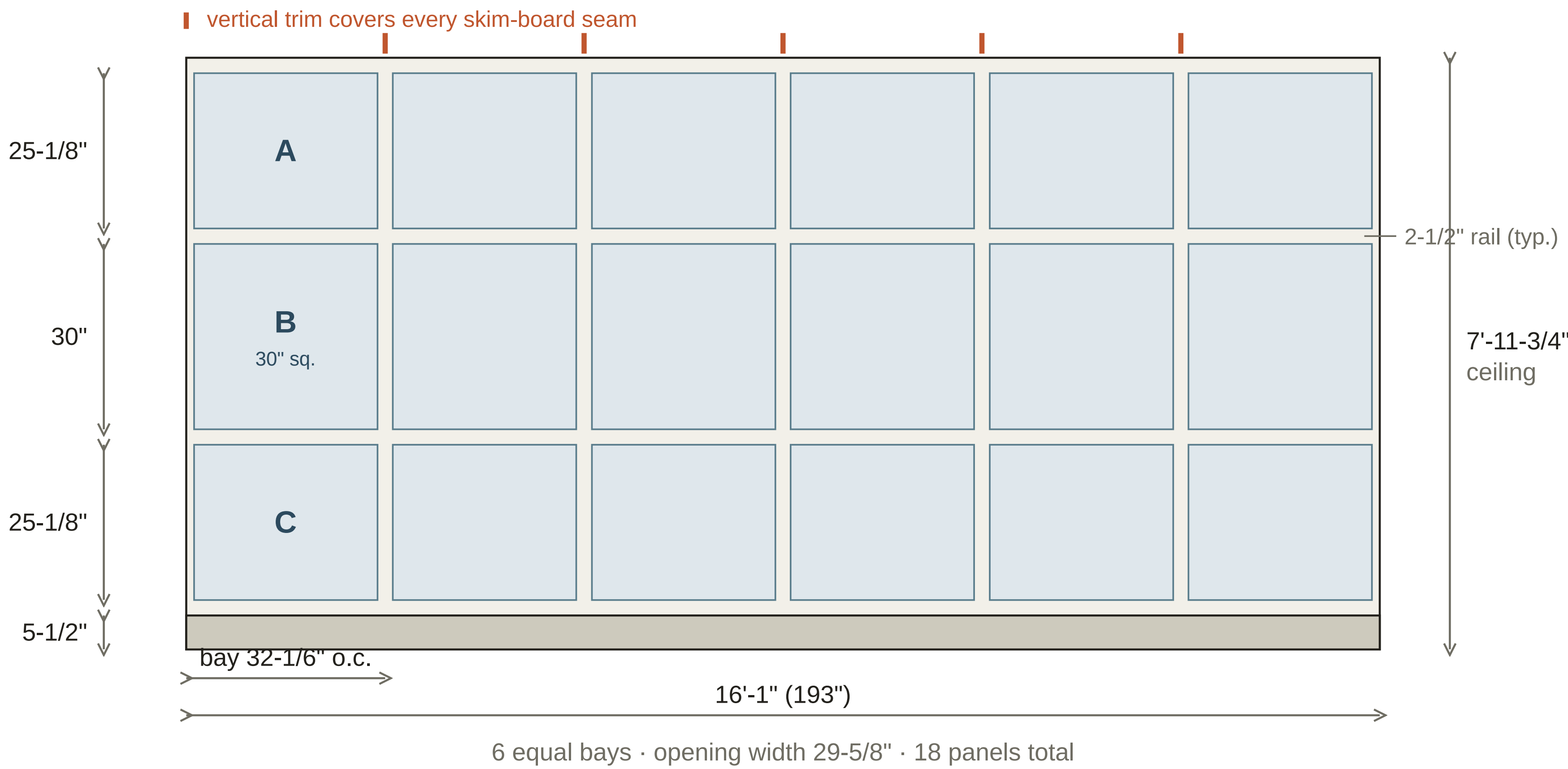


6 equal bays · opening width 30-7/8" · 18 panels total

Field notes — R1: Stair descends in front of the lower-left of this wall. Panel the full wall floor-to-ceiling at apartment level; field-confirm the baseboard termination at the stair stringer. Existing windows: grid dies into existing casing - hold a trim member each side of the casing. Existing window casing is painted (not re-cased).

R2 — Living long wall

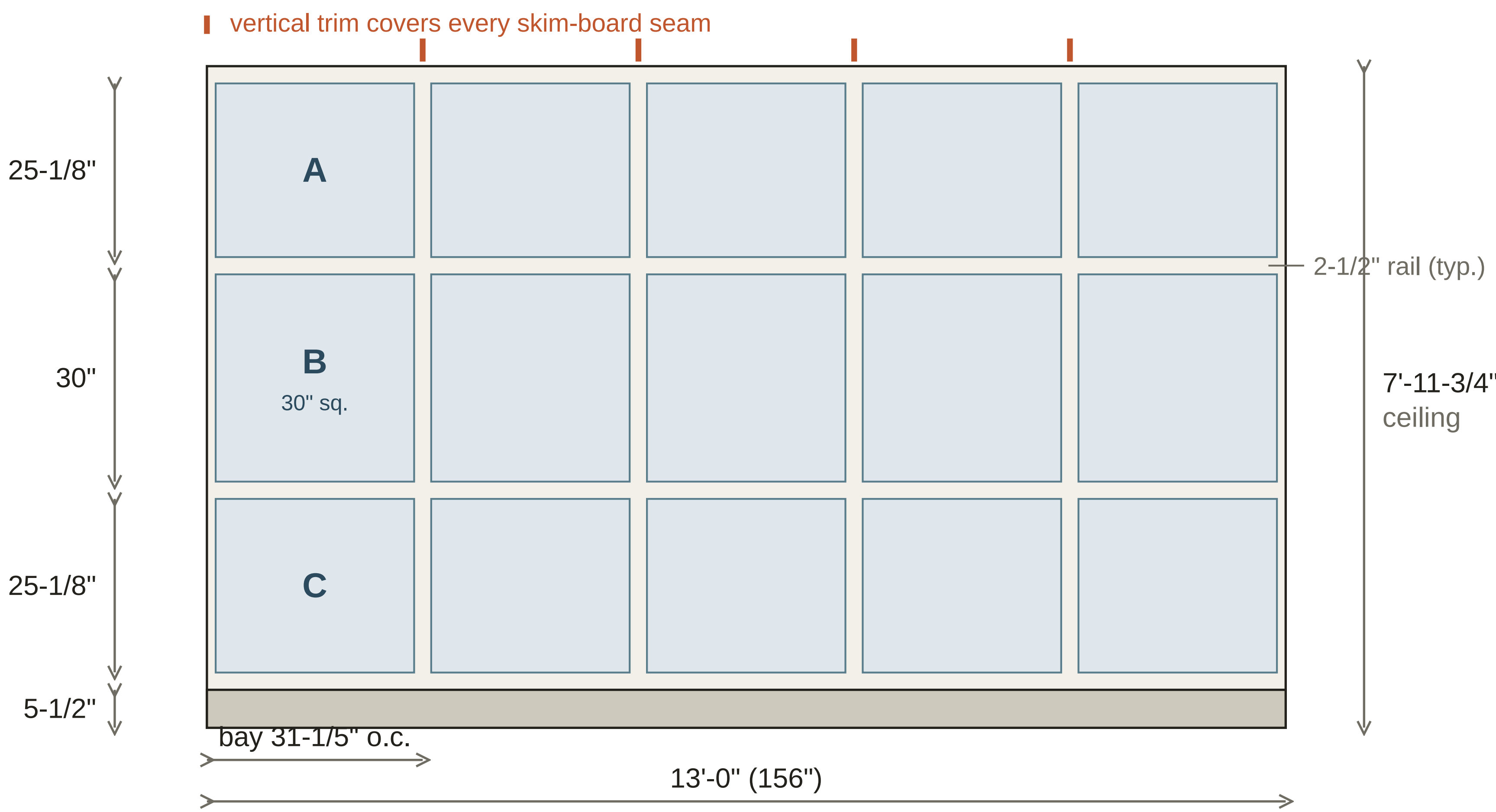
Left exterior wall, living portion · 16'-1" · 6 bays · 18 panels



Field notes — R2: Continuous with R1 along the same exterior wall. Wood stove sits in front of the lower portion - panel the wall behind it, but hold MDF back from the stove per combustible-clearance requirements (field condition - confirm clearance). Existing windows: grid dies into existing casing.

R3 — Dining end wall

Wall between dining area and kitchen side · 13'-0" · 5 bays · 15 panels

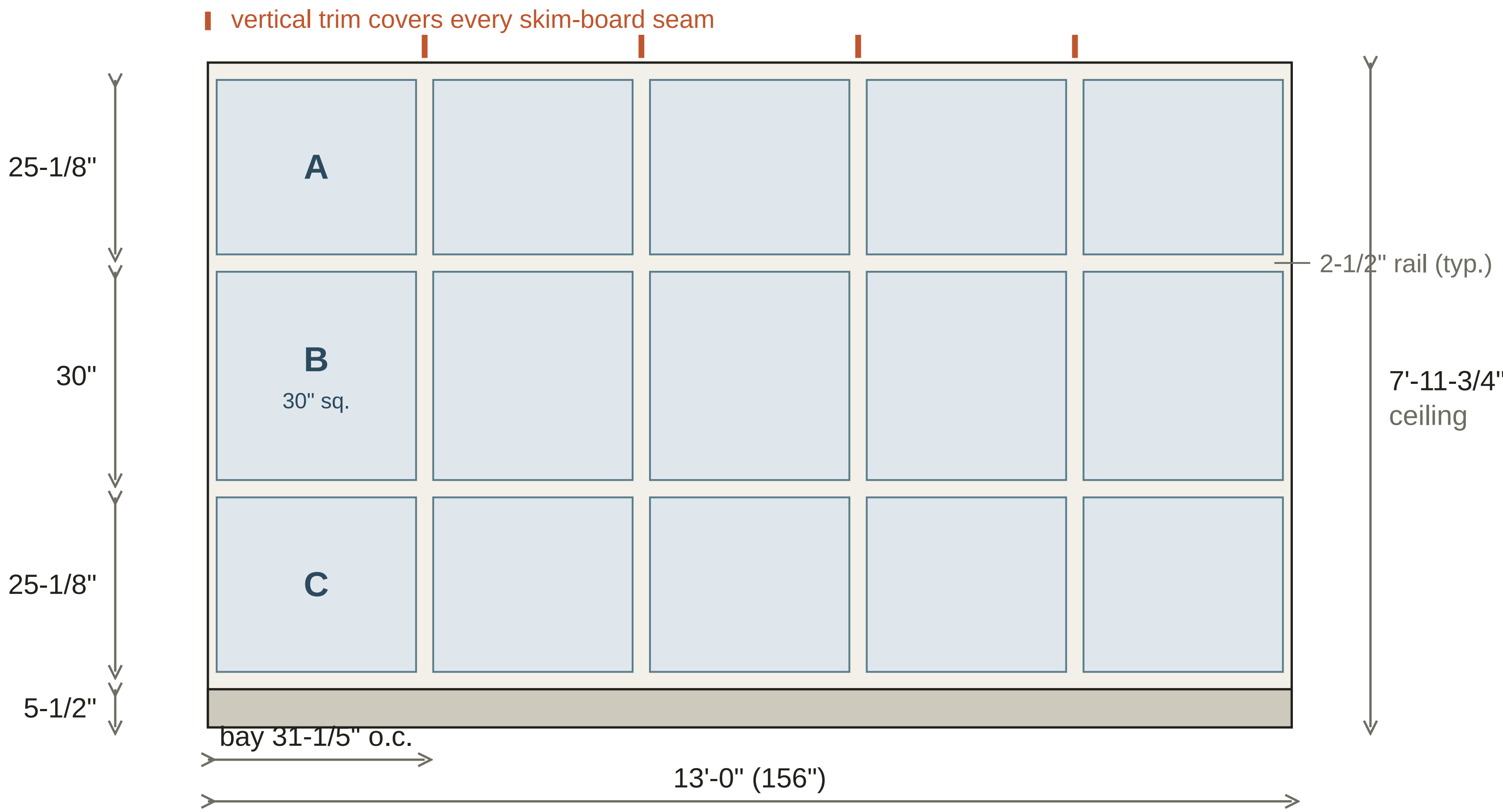


5 equal bays · opening width 28-3/4" · 15 panels total

Field notes — R3: Field-confirm net paneled length where this wall meets the kitchen / built-in-bar opening on the right - the opening is NOT paneled.

R4 — Living end wall

Lower wall of the living room · 13'-0" · 5 bays · 15 panels



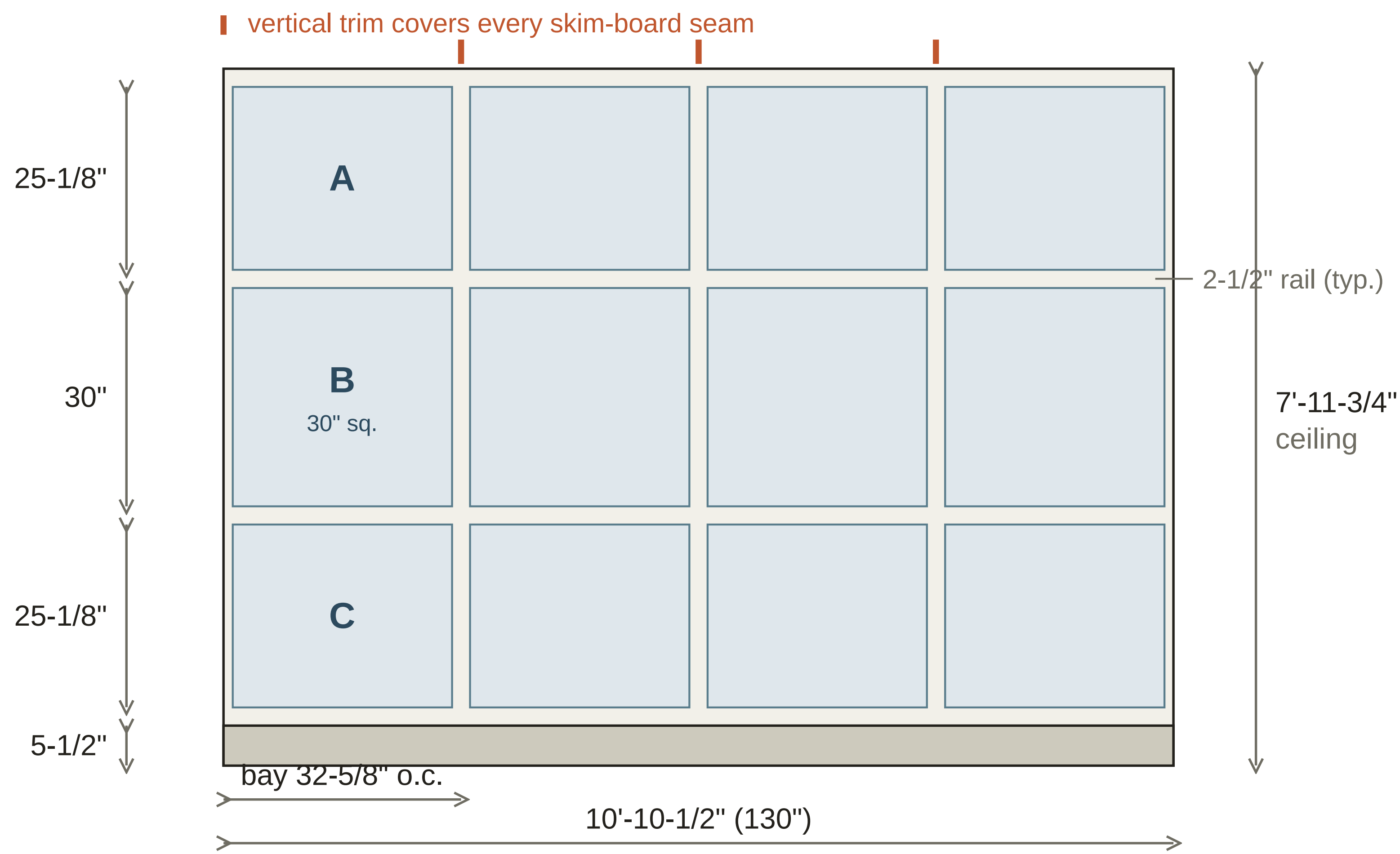
5 equal bays · opening width 28-3/4" · 15 panels total

Field notes — R4: Wood stove and windows on this wall - grid dies into existing window casing; coordinate trim layout around the stove hearth and observe combustible clearance to the stove.

Dimensions approximate (LiDAR survey) - field-verify before cutting

R6 — Inside-L wall (bedroom to corner)

Inside face of the L - bedroom entry to inside corner · 10'-10-1/2" · 4 bays · 12 panels

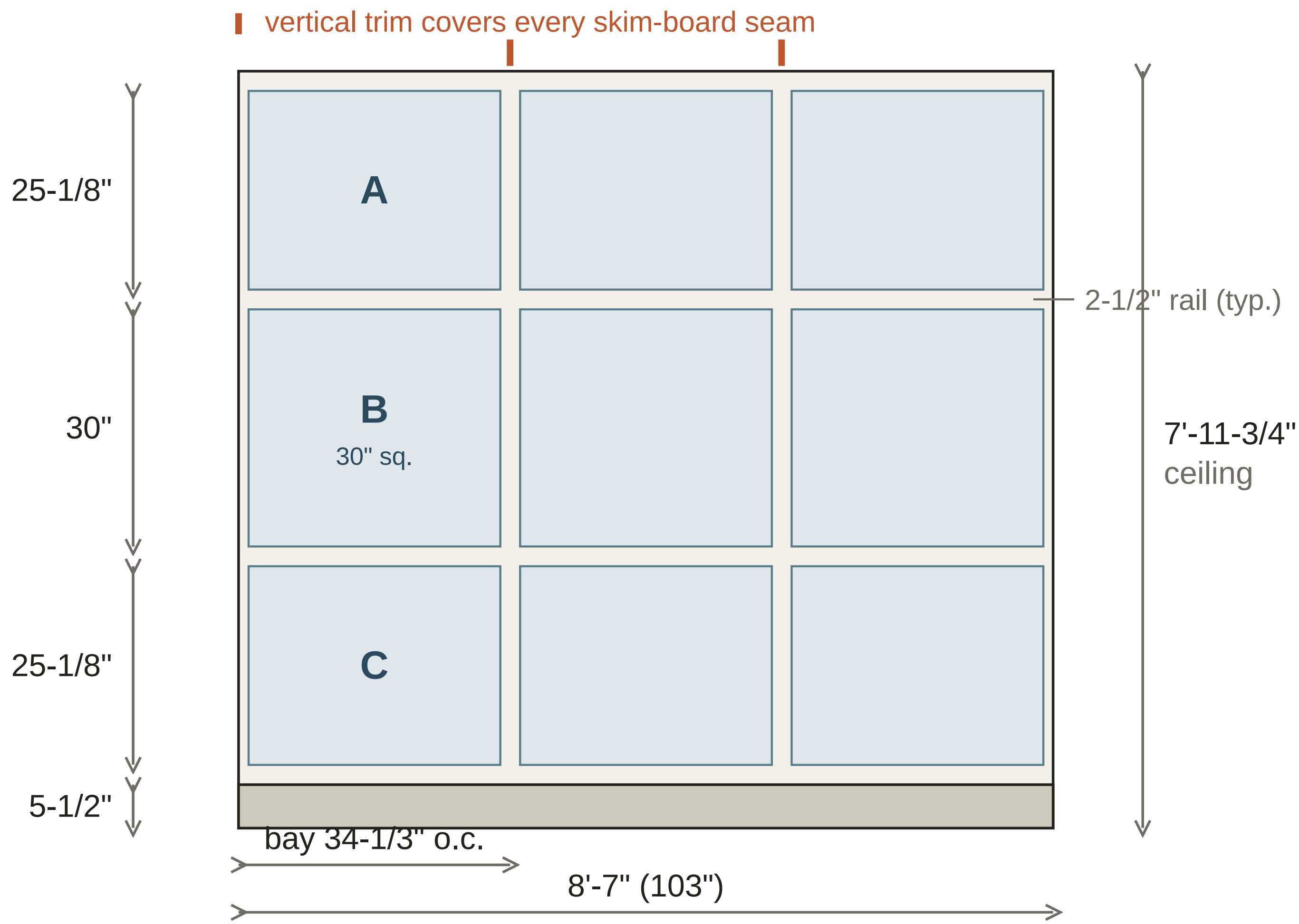


4 equal bays · opening width 30-1/8" · 12 panels total

Field notes — R6: Runs from the bedroom entry door to the inside corner of the L. The bedroom ENTRY door stays as a cased opening - grid dies into its casing both sides. The small bathroom's old living-room door is SEALED and paneled over as solid wall (bathroom becomes en-suite, accessed only from the bedroom). Built from measurement segments P (75-3/8"), O (28-1/8", the sealed door), and N (27"). Field-verify total length and the sealed-door framing before cutting.

R5-a — Bump-out - outer window wall

Bump-out / former primary bedroom · 8'-7" · 3 bays · 9 panels · same vertical rhythm as all runs

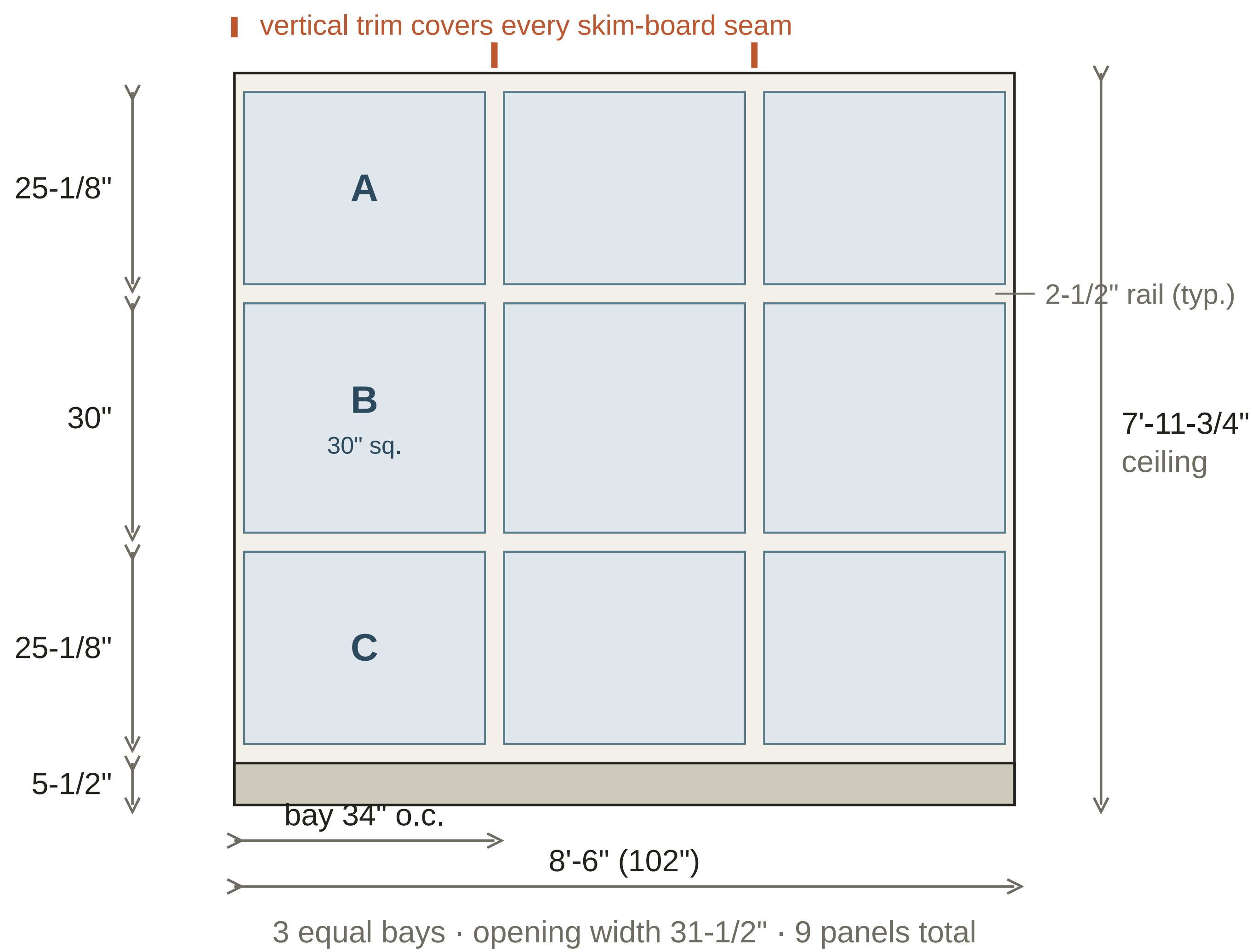


3 equal bays · opening width 31-7/8" · 9 panels total

Field notes — R5-a: Part of the former primary bedroom alcove (wall G removed to open it to the great room). Segment length is approximate — LiDAR survey — measure on site before cutting. Confirm the corner condition where this segment returns into the adjacent R5 segment.

R5-b — Bump-out - return wall

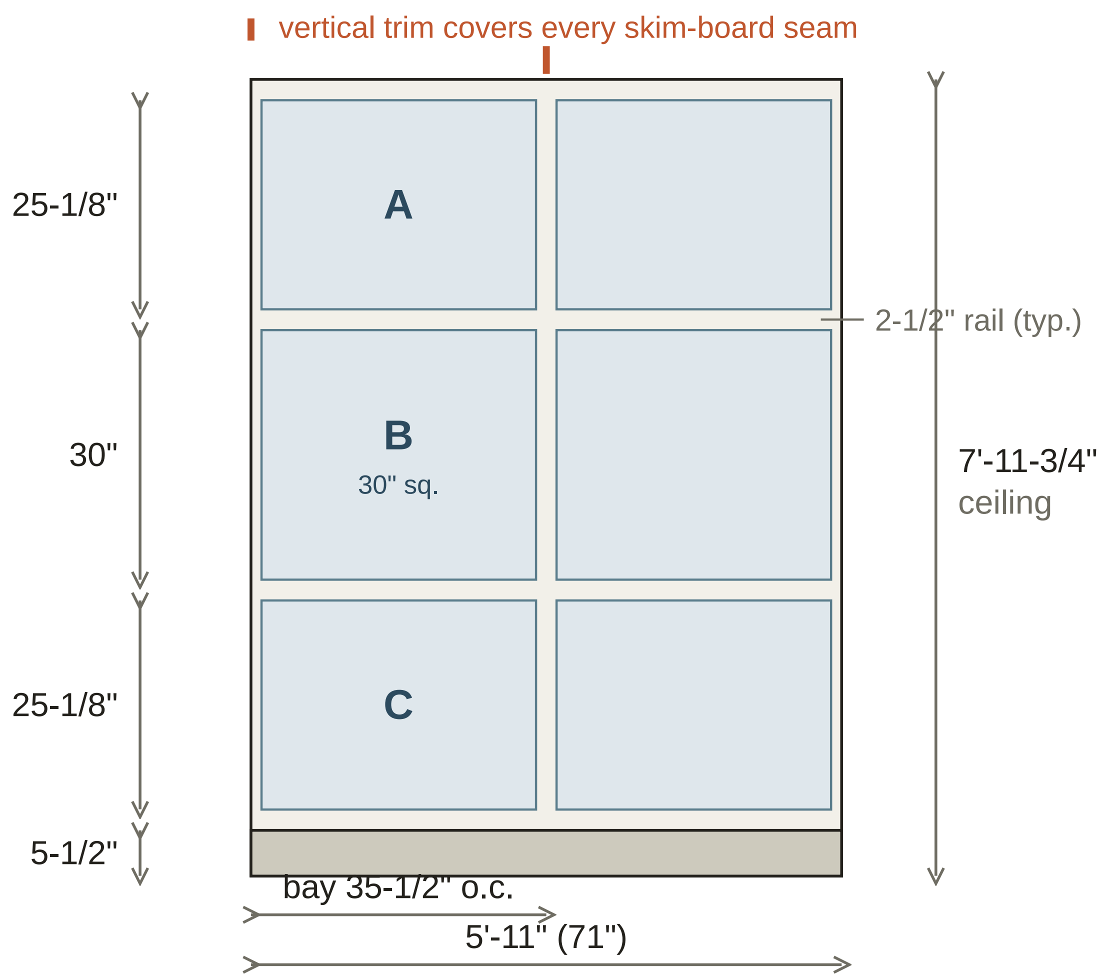
Bump-out / former primary bedroom · 8'-6" · 3 bays · 9 panels · same vertical rhythm as all runs



Field notes — R5-b: Part of the former primary bedroom alcove (wall G removed to open it to the great room). Segment length is approximate — LiDAR survey — measure on site before cutting. Confirm the corner condition where this segment returns into the adjacent R5 segment.

R5-c — Bump-out - short return wall

Bump-out / former primary bedroom · 5'-11" · 2 bays · 6 panels · same vertical rhythm as all runs



2 equal bays · opening width 33" · 6 panels total

Field notes — R5-c: Part of the former primary bedroom alcove (wall G removed to open it to the great room). Segment length is approximate — LiDAR survey — measure on site before cutting. Confirm the corner condition where this segment returns into the adjacent R5 segment.

Method & materials notes

Substrate & seam strategy

- Skin all paneled walls with hardboard for a flat, texture-free substrate before any trim goes up.
- Rip skim sheets to the bay width of each run (see Sheet 1 schedule). Every sheet seam must land under a vertical trim member.
- Ripping 48" sheets to ~31–34" leaves a ~14–16" offcut per sheet — usable on the short R5 segments; expect ~30–40% more hardboard than a plain area calc.

Trim grid

- Vertical members and horizontal rails: ripped from 1×6 primed MDF to a 2-1/2" face width.
- Four horizontal rails per wall: at ceiling, between A/B, between B/C, and at top of baseboard.
- Top rail is a flat 1×6 at the ceiling line — no cove or cap profile (matches the Jenna Sue full-wainscoting reference). Quarter-round is carried as a contingency only, to scribe out an uneven ceiling line if needed.
- Baseboard: 5-1/2", new 1×6 MDF on the flat — existing contractor-grade base is removed and replaced. Pull existing base BEFORE skimming so hardboard runs to the floor.
- PVC base cap forms the recessed shadow line inside each of the 102 openings — 4 mitered pieces per panel.

Windows, doors & openings

- Existing window & door casing is kept and PAINTED the dark finish color — not re-cased. Grid dies into the existing casing; hold a trim member tight to each side.
- Allowance carried for re-wrapping one or two windows in flat stock if a casing profile is too bulky to paint out — carpenter to flag on site.
- R6: the bedroom entry door stays as a cased opening. The bathroom's old living-room door is sealed and paneled over as solid wall.
- Box extenders at all outlets / switches in paneled walls. Observe combustible clearance at the wood stove — do not run MDF tight to the stove.

Vertical rhythm (identical on every run)

Element	Dimension	Notes
Top rail	2-1/2"	At ceiling
Row A opening	≈ 25-1/8"	Equal to C - field-split
Mid rail	2-1/2"	Between A and B
Row B opening	30" (fixed)	The square hero panel
Mid rail	2-1/2"	Between B and C
Row C opening	≈ 25-1/8"	Equal to A - field-split
Bottom rail	2-1/2"	On top of baseboard
Baseboard	5-1/2"	1×6 MDF on the flat

Check: 2-1/2"×4 rails + 30" + (25-1/8"×2) + 5-1/2" baseboard = 7'-11-3/4" ceiling.

This packet is the build reference for the recessed-panel WALL scope only. Faux ceiling beams are a separate project with their own packet. It is also the structural reference for the photorealistic client renders to follow. Excludes labor, wall G demolition / structural sign-off, drywall patching at removed openings, the ceiling scope, and the built-in bar — all covered separately.